

Tony Dongfang Zhao

Full-stack designer and strategist
helping ambitious businesses
communicate value.

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Experience

Flow Studio	Design Lead 08/2025 - Present	▶ Led design engagements for 40+ tech companies, primarily AI startups backed by YC, PearX, and a16z, across fintech, deep tech, SaaS, crypto, AI security, hospitality, and more; taking projects from strategy and branding through production.
	Brand Designer 02/2025 - 08/2025	▶ Helped grow studio revenue 12× in under 10 months, from signing pre-seed startups through Series A companies; ▶ Personally designed 80%+ of studio output, including brand identity, web design, product design, campaigns, motion, launch videos, web production; ▶ Fully client-facing, working directly with founders from initial strategy and ideation through design and production; ▶ Supported clients through fundraising rounds averaging \$5M at seed stage; clients reported significant increases in inbound leads, including one company recently winning an RFP against a Series B competitor; ▶ Promoted to Design Lead in 6 month, since managing 3 freelance designers, coordinating external agencies, production teams, and developers; ▶ Established studio’s AI native workflow, expanding its service offering from design into web production and development;
Freelance Designer	06/2024 - Present	▶ Running an independent design practice, providing branding, web design, and marketing support for clients across editorial, advertising, and education. Clients include Off-Menu Magazine, Princeton STEM Initiative, and Cambridge Centre for International Research.
UCCA Museum	Marketing Strategist 01/2021 - 08/2021	▶ Supported museum exhibitions and public education programs, working directly with artists and curators on exhibition and promotional materials. Hosted public events and managed 3 social media accounts.

Expertise

Skills	Web Design, Motion, Branding, Brand Strategy, Visual Identity, Brand Guideline, Art Direction, Digital Design, Marketing Collateral, Campaign, Front End Production, Video Production, Editorial/Print Materials
AI Native Workflow	AI-assisted Research, Visual Exploration, Prototyping, Visual Production, Front-end Development
Softwares	Figma, Adobe CS, Microsoft Suite, Google Workplace, Jitter; ChatGPT, Claude, Cursor, HTML CSS JavaScript

Education

Rhode Island School of Design 09/2020 - 12/2024 BFA in Computer Graphics and Painting; Graduated with honor; Florence Leif Award Recipient
Brown University 09/2020 - 12/2024 Selected Courses in Type and Code, Motion Design, Politics of Reading, Scandinavian Literature, Contemporary Architecture, etc.